



The Invention of the Trillionaire

REVIEW

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL **WEEKEND**



Eating Up the World Cup

OFF DUTY

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Shares in SpaceX** soared 19% as Elon Musk's rocket-maker pulled off the largest IPO ever, becoming the sixth most valuable U.S. public company and turning him into the world's first trillionaire. **A1**

◆ **The Justice Department** cleared Paramount's \$81 billion purchase of Warner Bros. Discovery, removing one hurdle for the entertainment companies' megadeal. **B9**

◆ **Longtime bond investor** Ken Leech pleaded guilty in connection with a cherry-picking investment-fraud case just days before he was set to go to trial. **B10**

◆ **Investors in BlackRock's** flagship private-credit fund asked to redeem a collective 13.3% of the fund's shares in the second quarter, an increase from 9.3% in the previous period. **B10**

◆ **JBS is preparing to close** a beef-processing plant in Pennsylvania, the latest facility to close as a cattle shortage in the U.S. squeezes meatpacking companies. **B10**

◆ **FanDuel-owner Flutter** plans to delist from the London Stock Exchange. **B10**

◆ **The crypto-data provider** Blockworks said that it acquired its rival Messari in a deal underlining the pressures faced in a deepening bear market. **B9**

Worldwide

◆ **The U.S., Iran** and the chief mediator Pakistan all agreed that a peace deal to end the war was nearly complete, though an initial agreement would only kick-start the hardest part of nuclear negotiations over the coming months. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** is banning foreign governments, companies and individuals from using Anthropic's most powerful AI tools, prompting the company to shut off access to everyone to comply with the rule. **A4**

◆ **A coalition** of state attorneys general has opened an investigation into OpenAI for a broad range of its activities, according to people familiar with the matter. **A4**

◆ **A federal judge** stopped the Trump administration from proceeding with a \$1.8 billion payout fund, saying she wasn't satisfied with assurances it has been abandoned. **A5**

◆ **Cuban-Americans** are sustaining a Cuban population facing economic collapse by sending food and medicine. **A6**

◆ **Scammers are using AI** to create fake websites to impersonate phone companies, Google said. **A6**

◆ **China said it detained** a U.S. citizen on suspicion of endangering national security. **A8**

◆ **Died: David Hockney**, 88, famed British pop artist. **C6**

◆ **Gene Shalit**, 100, film critic. **A5**

◆ **PEGGY NOONAN** 'Rocky' and the love of America. **A13**

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SpaceX Soars in Record Debut

Largest initial public offering in history mints Musk as the world's first trillionaire in blockbuster day on Wall Street



People in New York City's Times Square watch a live feed of Elon Musk as SpaceX makes its debut on the Nasdaq exchange.

Musk's 'Superlative' Strategy Powered Company's Ascent

By TIM HIGGINS

Everything about the SpaceX IPO was befitting of Elon Musk's original goal. From the get-go, about 25 years ago, he wanted superlatives. He wanted to capture attention, to fuel imaginations and, in turn, to create public support—excitement—for space travel. This week, he got superlatives: the world's biggest IPO.

Tens of billions of dollars to fund his ambitions to put giant rocket ships into space, build out AI data centers in orbit and one day, just maybe, put a city on Mars with 1 million people. And to think, his earlier idea was so much smaller. To reignite waning interest in space travel, Musk had initially tried concocting a publicity stunt to send plant seeds to Mars in hope of sprouting new life there.

"The public tends to respond to precedence and superlatives," he explained during an appearance years ago at Stanford University. "This would be the furthest that life's ever traveled, the first life on Mars." Musk could imagine the photo of the green shoots against the Mars background. In his mind, it would spark interest in boosting NASA spending and a race to the planet.

In reality, he came to realize the big hurdle to space travel was the cost of one-time-use rockets. This sent him on a path to found SpaceX in 2002 with the idea of building reusable rockets. It is easy to laugh at the *Please turn to page A4*

◆ **Bank has key role for IPO: party host.....** **A2**

Shares in SpaceX soared 19% Friday as Elon Musk's rocket-maker pulled off the largest initial public offering ever and turned Musk into the world's first trillionaire.

By Corrie Driebusch, Becky Peterson and Micah Maidenber

The company, valued at \$1.77 trillion when it sold \$75 billion worth of shares a day earlier, ended its first day of trading with a market value of \$2.1 trillion, putting it ahead of Broadcom and Tesla to make it the sixth most valuable public company in the U.S. The offering handed long-standing SpaceX investors and employees billions of dollars in collective gains. It was powered by an army of individual investors who bought into Musk's moonshot vision of putting data centers in space to support the rise of artificial-intelligence. Ahead of the debut, some on Wall Street wondered whether the financial system's machinery would support the sheer size of the offering and whether investors would show up en masse for an unprofitable venture that sees much of its future revenue coming not from its space or internet *Please turn to page A2*



Aging Poses Test As Trump Turns 80

By ANNIE LINSKEY

WASHINGTON—President Trump closed his eyes and appeared to nod off while seated in a suite at an NBA Finals game in New York City this past week as cameras caught him snacking on french fries and pizza. He returned to the White House after 2 a.m. By 10 a.m. the next day, he offered a lengthy critique of a recently published Wall Street Journal editorial to a reporter who called him on his cell-phone, and said the downing of a U.S. Apache helicopter near the Strait of Hormuz "wasn't a big deal." Hours later, he ordered strikes on Iran in retaliation for the incident. As Trump approaches his 80th birthday on Sunday, he and his advisers have made a strategic decision to turn the president into an omnipresent figure in American life, drawing a contrast with his octogenarian predecessor, Joe Biden. Trump makes regular marathon appearances in the Oval Office, he answers reporters' cold calls and he tees off on social media at all hours of the day and night. The result is that Americans are seeing more of both the good and the bad of an aging president. In question-and-answer sessions that sometimes last more than 30 minutes, the president *Please turn to page A5*

EXCHANGE



A SQUEEZE

McDonald's is no longer happy planning every meal around Coke. **B1**

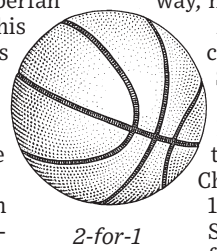
Their Weddings Were All Planned. Then Came 'Knicks in 5.'

* * *

Saturday nuptials are competing with another blissful event: the NBA Finals Game 5

By JENNIFER CALFAS

Days before his wedding, New York Knicks superfan Kevin Kelly sent his group-chat guidelines for their attendance: watching the NBA Finals during the reception will not be sanctioned. "Everybody turn in a good performance, get out on the dance floor and the reward will be at the after party downstairs with TVs on for the second half starting at 10:30," Kelly said. Knicks games really pick up then anyway, he assured them. After a stunning comeback against the San Antonio Spurs Wednesday, the Knicks could clinch their first NBA Championship since 1973 with a win on Saturday. For some fans, that basketball fever dream is creating a wedding nightmare. *Please turn to page A10*



U.S., Iran Are Said To Be Close to Pact

The U.S., Iran and the chief mediator from Pakistan all agreed Friday that a peace deal to end the war was nearly complete, though an initial agreement would only kick-start the hardest part of nuclear negotiations over the coming months. A senior Trump administration official said he was around 80% confident that a deal would be reached in the next few days. It would include an Iranian commitment not to develop or procure a nuclear weapon and Tehran's promise that it would destroy its stockpile of highly enriched uranium, the official said. The deal would be structured in a way that Iran receives sanctions relief and economic benefits for the specific steps it takes to wind back its nuclear program, according to the official. If Iran decommis- *Please turn to page A7*

Switzerland's Radical Immigration Proposal

Country to vote on a population cap

By TOM FAIRLESS

ZUG, Switzerland—This Alpine nation has long relied on its geography to keep the world at bay. But with its valleys filling up, some here are pushing to replace natural barriers with something even more unyielding: a population cap. Disgruntled by rising living costs and disillusioned by unfulfilled economic and social promises, the Swiss are at the vanguard of industrialized countries questioning the benefits of immigration, even the high-skilled workers many vie to attract. On Sunday, they will vote in a referendum to put a hard ceiling on the country's population. Since 2000, the number of foreign-born residents has jumped from around one in five to one in three—the second-highest level among rich countries next to tiny Luxembourg, and compared with one in six in the U.S. That represents an enormous demographic shift for *Please turn to page A10*